

Airtable to Salesforce: what loaded, what didn't, and why

A reconciliation of every Airtable table against the records now in the Salesforce sandbox, the transformations applied along the way, and the decisions still needed from the Partnerships team.

Environment gsa-peo sandbox Report date 13 August 2026 Source Airtable, pulled 12 August 2026

Where things stand

Ten of the eleven data sets now hold records in Salesforce; Meetings has not been started. Every record that could be loaded without guessing at ambiguous data has been. The gaps below are almost entirely traceable to a handful of source-data issues, most of which release a large number of records at once.

6,735	10 / 11	169	1,845
Records created or updated in Salesforce	Data sets loaded, in whole or in part	Unmatched accounts — the largest single blocker	Meetings not yet started

THE ONE NUMBER TO WATCH

A single issue — **169 Airtable account rows that don't match an account already in Salesforce** — is responsible for the majority of every other gap on this page. It blocks partner accounts, which blocks applications, which blocks the application–contact links. Resolving those 169 rows would pull several hundred additional records into Salesforce with no further engineering work.

Record reconciliation

Airtable row counts against what is now in Salesforce. A negative difference is not necessarily data loss — in several cases it is intentional consolidation, explained in the final column.

DATA SET	AIRTABLE	SALESFORCE	DIFF	%	STATUS	EXPLANATION
Market Segments	6	6	0	100%	COMPLETE	Loaded previously; untouched by this migration.

DATA SET	AIRTABLE	SALESFORCE	DIFF	%	STATUS	EXPLANATION
Accounts	757	588	-169	77.7%	NEEDS DECISIONS	Accounts already existed in Salesforce, so these were matched rather than created. 169 Airtable rows matched nothing. Spot-checking found most are duplicate rows <i>within Airtable</i> — e.g. "Army" alongside "Department of the Army".
Partner Accounts	99	74	-25	74.7%	NEEDS DECISIONS	20 are blocked by the unmatched accounts above. 5 have no usable account link at all (4 marked inactive, 1 linked to two accounts).
Contacts	2,119	1,936	-183	91.4%	LOADED	Source is two tables: 1,599 Contacts + 520 Opportunity Contacts. The difference is mostly <i>intentional</i> — the same person appearing on several rows was consolidated into one contact. 45 rows had neither a name nor an email and could not be loaded; 8 were rejected as duplicates of existing Salesforce contacts.
Opportunities	928	742	-186	80.0%	NEEDS DECISIONS	142 blocked by unmatched accounts, 28 have no status recorded, 16 have no account link.

DATA SET	AIRTABLE	SALESFORCE	DIFF	%	STATUS	EXPLANATION
Applications	1,064	688	-376	64.7%	NEEDS DECISIONS	359 are blocked because their partner account hasn't loaded — again tracing back to the unmatched accounts. 17 have no partner account link (6 retired applications, 11 in-progress drafts).
Impediments	41	39	-2	95.1%	LOADED	2 rows are entirely blank and look like accidental empty records.
Application ↔ Contact links	2,797	1,880	-917	67.2%	PARTIAL	A link can only exist once both sides do; 849 are waiting on an application that hasn't loaded. 33 were duplicates created by consolidating contacts and were merged.
Impediment ↔ Opportunity links	783	267	-516	34.1%	NEEDS DECISIONS	465 of these point at a single impediment named "None", which we believe is a placeholder meaning <i>no impediment</i> — see below. 44 more await an opportunity that hasn't loaded.
Opportunity contact roles	520	515	-5	99.0%	LOADED	437 of 520 source rows loaded, producing 515 role records because some people hold more than one role. 83 rows await an opportunity or contact.
Meetings	1,845	0	-1,845	0%	NOT STARTED	Not yet built. Needs one decision first — see "Still to come".

The contacts finding

This is the most consequential thing we learned about the source data, and it changes how contacts should be maintained in Airtable going forward.

The contacts attached to opportunities are a separate population

Airtable has a **Contacts** table (1,599 rows) and, separately, an **Opportunity Contacts** table (520 rows). We expected the second to reference the first. It does not — it has no link to the Contacts table at all, only a typed name and an email address.

When we checked those 520 people against the Contacts table:

- **65** existed in the Contacts table.
- **348** did not appear there at all.
- **107** had no email address recorded, only a name.

In other words, roughly two-thirds of the people attached to opportunities existed nowhere else in the base. They had to be created as contacts in their own right before their roles on opportunities could be recorded — a separate load, not a lookup.

WHY THIS MATTERS BEYOND THE MIGRATION

Salesforce treats a person as one record who can be attached to many opportunities and applications. Airtable currently has no equivalent link, so the same person gets typed in again for each thing they're involved with. That's why the Contacts table also contains duplicates: **61 email addresses appear on two or more rows**, one of them four times. We consolidated those into single contacts on load, but the underlying pattern will keep producing duplicates until Airtable has a proper way to link one person to several applications.

A related case: the same person, several roles

62 of the opportunity contact rows list more than one role for the same person on the same opportunity — for example *Senior POC + Decision Maker + Day-to-Day POC*. Salesforce stores one role per record, so this needed an explicit decision rather than a default.

Decision: create one record per role

The alternative was to pick a single “most senior” role and discard the others, which would have silently lost information the team had deliberately recorded.

Salesforce permits the same contact to hold several roles on one opportunity, so all of them are preserved. Where someone is also marked as the primary contact, that flag is applied once per opportunity, as Salesforce requires.

Effect: 437 source rows produced 515 role records. Nothing was discarded.

Transformations applied

Data rarely moves across unchanged. These are the substantive conversions — the cases where a value in Salesforce deliberately differs from what's in Airtable.

Corrections made automatically

- **“Decomissioned” → “Decommissioned”** — a misspelling on 89 application records, corrected on load. Worth fixing at source so it isn't retyped.
- **“Gov?t Employees” → “Gov't Employees”** — 25 opportunity records have a question mark where an apostrophe should be. We confirmed this is genuinely stored that way in Airtable, not a glitch in our export.
- **Impediment categories** — “Issue on their end” and “Relationship Issue” were mapped to the equivalent Salesforce values.
- **Placeholder text removed** — “TBD” entries in web address fields were left blank rather than stored as if they were real links.

Values added to Salesforce so nothing was lost

- **Demographic Served** — Airtable uses 32 categories where Salesforce offered 6. We analysed each category by how recently it was used and added the 24 in active use within the last 18 months. Only 8 genuinely dormant categories were left out, affecting about 28 records rather than the ~400 a simple match would have dropped.
- **Contact roles** — “Day-to-Day POC” and “Senior POC” did not exist in Salesforce. Rather than forcing them into an approximate existing role, both were added.
- **Opportunity type and service level** — several values used throughout Airtable were not selectable on Login.gov opportunities. They were enabled, which also fixed revenue calculations that depend on them.

Fields deliberately not migrated

- **Calculated fields** — revenue totals, completion percentages and similar are recalculated by Salesforce from the underlying data, so writing them across would be overwritten anyway.
- **Market Segment** — set automatically from the related account.
- **Confirmed not needed** — Pilots, Usage Tracker Application Name, Vital Update %, and Issuer Strings, per earlier decisions.

Decisions taken during the load

Where the source data was ambiguous, we stopped rather than guessed. These are the calls that were made, and what each one cost or preserved.

The impediment named “None” was not migrated

One impediment record is named “None”, has no description, and is linked to 465 opportunities — more than five times any real impediment.

Loading it would have asserted that 297 opportunities *are* impeded, and because Salesforce totals blocked revenue per impediment, “None” would have appeared at the top of any “biggest blockers” report with a meaningless multi-million-dollar figure.

Effect: the 267 links from genuine impediments loaded and now show real figures. Reversing this decision takes one setting, not a rebuild.

Contacts without a name were loaded using their email address

Only 491 of 1,599 contacts have a name recorded. Salesforce requires a last name on every contact.

Rather than drop them or invent names, the email address is used as a visible placeholder, so the affected records are easy to find and correct later.

Effect: no contacts lost. About 971 look like real individuals whose name simply wasn't recorded; roughly 116 look like shared mailboxes.

Unmatched accounts were left for human review, not auto-created

169 Airtable account rows match no existing Salesforce account. Creating them automatically would have produced duplicate agency records, since spot-checking showed most are duplicate rows within Airtable rather than genuinely new organisations.

Effect: the largest remaining gap, but a reversible one — each resolved account releases its partner accounts, applications and links automatically.

What we need from you

In rough order of how many records each one unblocks.

HIGHEST IMPACT **Resolve the 169 unmatched accounts**

For each, tell us whether it duplicates an existing account (and which one is correct), is genuinely new, or is stale. This alone unblocks partner accounts, applications and several hundred links.

DECISION **Confirm what the “None” impediment means**

If it means “no impediment”, the cleanest fix is to remove those links in Airtable and delete the record.

DECISION **Service accounts and shared mailboxes**

Roughly 116 contacts are addresses like a help desk rather than people. Should they be contacts at all, or handled another way?

DATA ENTRY **Names for approximately 971 contacts**

The single highest-value cleanup available — ideally captured as first and last name rather than one free-text field.

DATA ENTRY **28 opportunities have no status**

and 16 have no account link, so they cannot be created in Salesforce.

- DECISION

Confirm the record ownership rules

Which account should own records whose Airtable owner has no Salesforce account; whether applications and contacts should take their account's owner; and whether existing accounts' ownership should be left alone. See "Record ownership" above.
- PROVISIONING

Four opportunity leads have no Salesforce account

Covering 285 opportunities between them. Two are already on this list from the partner account review, so resolving them fixes ownership in both places.
- CLARIFY

Does "Technical Emails" mean "Technical POC"?

716 contacts carry this subscription value, which has no Salesforce equivalent. We did not assume the two are the same.
- CLARIFY

Seven opportunities are marked as both blocked by and requesting the same impediment.

We recorded these as blocked, being the more severe reading.

Building the automated loading process

The goal is a repeatable process the team can re-run, not a one-time copy of the data. That distinction matters when reading the table above: a data set can be fully automated and still be mostly unloaded, because it is waiting on source data rather than on engineering. Applications is exactly that — built, tested and proven, but only 65% loaded.

Each data set moves through four stages. *Pull* reads Airtable directly through its API. *Transform* converts it and checks it against what Salesforce will actually accept. *Load* writes it. *Verified* means we confirmed the result in Salesforce rather than trusting the load report.

DATA SET	PULL	TRANSFORM	LOAD	VERIFIED	AUTOMATION NOTES
Accounts	✓	✓	✓	✓	Matches existing accounts rather than creating them, and writes anything it can't match confidently to a review file instead of guessing.
Partner Accounts	✓	✓	✓	✓	Re-runs pick up newly-resolved accounts automatically.
Contacts	✓	✓	✓	✓	Consolidates duplicate people across both source tables as part of the transform.
Opportunities	✓	✓	✓	✓	Required two Salesforce configuration changes, both applied.
Applications	✓	✓	✓	✓	Fully automated; the gap is source data, not the process.
Impediments	✓	✓	✓	✓	Complete apart from two blank source rows.

DATA SET	PULL	TRANSFORM	LOAD	VERIFIED	AUTOMATION NOTES
Application ↔ Contact links	✓	✓	✓	✓	Re-running can't create duplicates, by design.
Impediment ↔ Opportunity links	✓	✓	✓	✓	The "None" exclusion is a setting, not a code change.
Opportunity contact roles	✓	✓	✓	✓	Cannot use the usual matching key, so it compares against existing records instead. Re-running is still safe.
Meetings	✓	—	—	—	Data pulls fine; the transform is blocked on the meeting-duration decision below.
Notes	✓	—	—	—	Deliberately last — a note must attach to a record that already exists.
Record ownership	✓	—	—	—	Not yet built. See below.

WHAT "AUTOMATED" BUYS YOU

Every step re-reads Airtable and re-checks Salesforce each time it runs. That means the cleanup items on this page don't need an engineer to act on them individually — correcting the source data and re-running is enough to bring the newly-valid records across. Nothing has to be re-keyed by hand, and re-running cannot duplicate what is already loaded.

Record ownership

Raised by the Partnerships team and not yet built. Worth calling out separately because it affects who can see what, not just how reports read.

Every record the migration created is currently owned by the person who ran the load. Accounts are the exception — they were matched to records that already existed, so their original owners survived.

That matters more than it might appear: these objects use owner-based sharing, so the owner determines visibility, not just the "Owner" column on a report.

Proposed rule

Where Airtable records an owner and that person has a Salesforce account, assign the record to them. Where they don't, fall back to a single default owner.

This never leaves a record unowned and never invents an owner. Applied to today's data:

- **Opportunities** — 15 named leads. 11 have Salesforce accounts, covering **541 opportunities**. The other 4 cover 285, which would fall back.
- **Partner Accounts** — 5 of 7 owners resolve, covering 62 records.
- **Applications** — 5 of 7 resolve, covering 847 records.
- **Accounts and Contacts** — Airtable records no owner at all, so these need a decision rather than a rule.

Note: the four Opportunity leads without Salesforce accounts include two people already flagged on this list for the same reason — the same missing accounts block ownership in two places, so provisioning them fixes both.

Four questions before this can be built: which account should be the fallback owner; whether Applications should take their account's owner (Airtable has no application-specific owner); whether Contacts should do the same; and whether the migration should change ownership of accounts that already existed in Salesforce, or leave those untouched.

Still to come

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- **Record ownership** — assigning owners from the Airtable data rather than leaving everything with the person who ran the load. Rules proposed above; needs four decisions before it can be built.
 - **Meetings (1,845 records)** — Airtable records only a date, with no start or end time. Salesforce calendar events need both, so we need an agreed default duration before loading.
 - **Notes** — freeform Airtable columns with no dedicated Salesforce field (for example partner account descriptions and known blockers) become attached notes. This runs last, once every record it attaches to exists.
 - **Broker application relationships** — a small follow-up pass linking applications to their parent application.
 - **A re-run after cleanup** — every load re-reads Airtable, so fixing the items above and re-running picks up the newly valid records with no additional engineering.

Counts were taken directly from the gsa-peo sandbox on 13 August 2026 and from the Airtable export pulled 12 August 2026. Because both systems remain in active use, figures will drift; this report is a snapshot, not a live view. Full field-by-field mapping detail and the complete list of data-quality items are maintained alongside the migration scripts.